

BESMART program

“Buprenorphine Enhanced Supportive Medication-Assisted Recovery and Treatment”

Began in 2019, TennCare only. Reported benefits for BESMART:

- (1) clinical and care coordination support for MCOs
- (2) increased data on quality and health outcomes
- (3) enhanced reimbursement from MCOs for defined BESMART services
- (4) access to monoprodut buprenorphine
- (5) shortened prior authorization form.

Why become a BESMART Provider?

Consider if you:

- ...have a large TennCare buprenorphine population
- ...typically prescribe below 16/20mg of Buprenorphine: won't have to do the PA form
- ...have APPs on your team who would help with monitoring and prescribing
- ...are an APP who works with a physician who supports your prescribing of this product

Reference: <https://www.tn.gov/content/dam/tn/tenncare/documents/BESMARTProgramDescription.pdf>

Prescriber Criteria for inclusion in BESMART program

All providers must hold an active DEA with the authority to prescribe controlled substances.

Network Provider Eligibility: A physician who holds an unrestricted license from the Tennessee Board of Medical Examiners or the Tennessee Board of Osteopathic Examination

OR

A Nurse Practitioner (NP) or Physician Assistant (PA) who holds an unrestricted license from the respective state licensing board and meets the requirements to provide buprenorphine product as outlined in Public Chapters 761 and 771 of 2020. The NP or PA must practice under a supervising physician who holds an active, unrestricted DEA *and is contracted with the MCO's BESMART Network*. The NP or PA does not exceed their patient limit according to state law .

BESMART Prior Authorization Process

<https://www.tn.gov/content/dam/tn/tenncare/documents/UpdatesTennCareBuprenorphinePriorAuthorizationCriteriaMemo.pdf>

1. If you are a BESMART Provider, you won't be subject to the PA process below certain doses. See the above document.
2. If you are a physician in TennCare network who is not a BESMART provider, you will need to complete the prior authorization through TennCare. NP/PA who are not BESMART enrolled **cannot** prescribe buprenorphine product to TennCare patients. [Buprenorphine-Products-PA-Form.pdf](https://contenthub-aem.optumrx.com/content/dam/contenthub/rx-assets/en/documents/clients/tenncare/Buprenorphine-Products-PA-Form.pdf) <https://contenthub-aem.optumrx.com/content/dam/contenthub/rx-assets/en/documents/clients/tenncare/Buprenorphine-Products-PA-Form.pdf>
3. PA responses occur within 24 hours from Optum Rx.

Other Insurance Carrier Prior Authorization Process

These vary. For commercial and other patients, each program may have different prior authorization requirements. The information in the BESMART Prior Authorization can serve as a guide for what may be requested, as it is often more comprehensive than most programs.

CME Requirements

One time only 8 hours of CME options can be found here: <https://www.samhsa.gov/medications-substance-use-disorders/training-requirements-mate-act-resources>

Additional training in OUD treatments is recommended, but no X waiver is required any longer, since 2023.

Reference Materials

Complete prescribing guidelines from the state:

https://www.tn.gov/content/dam/tn/mentalhealth/documents/Bupe_Treatment_Guidelines_Fall_2023.pdf

Quick Start guide for prescribers: <https://pcssnow.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/04/quick-start-guide.pdf>

The six page SAMHSA guide provides the overview of prescribing this essential medication.